STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-6240
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **12/04/06**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT BATONS	CROSS REFERENCE G-6100 USE OF FORCE G-6110 USE OF FORCE REPORTING REQUIREMENTS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for carry and use of batons.

II. Policy:

Deputies of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall use batons only in accordance with established use of force policies and procedures (see G-6100 Use of Force). Only those expandable batons approved by the Sheriff shall be utilized. The Training Sergeant shall maintain a listing of approved expandable batons. Only expandable batons shall be authorized for carry and use. Reference is made to batons, but this shall not limit the use of other appropriate impact weapons (e.g. flashlights) when done in accordance with the use of force policy.

III. Procedures:

A. Training: Only trained and certified deputies shall carry or utilize a baton.

1. Deputies shall recertify every two (2) years.

2. Deputies shall utilize batons as instructed.

B. Carry Requirements: When on duty and in uniform (with the exception of those deputies working inside of the jail or Sheriff's Office), deputies shall carry a baton on their duty belt, unless carrying a taser (see G-6220 Taser).

C. Baton Use: Batons shall be used in accordance with all Sheriff's Office training standards, policies and procedures. Batons shall only be used when justified according to the use of force policy (see G-6100 Use of Force).

1. When tactically feasible, verbal commands shall be given prior to, during and after the use of a baton.

2. The primary targets for the baton are the major muscle groups and motor points in the leg.

3. Intentional strikes to the head, neck, and groin with a baton shall be considered deadly force.

4. When a deputy uses a baton, he or she shall use the baton only until the threat has been neutralized. When the behavior that justified the use of the baton ends, the deputy shall discontinue the use of the baton.

D. Post Deployment:

1. Any deputy using a baton shall immediately notify his or her supervisor. The supervisor shall respond to the scene.

2. The supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or ADC.

3. The on-scene supervisor shall photograph the subject and the baton impact areas as well as any secondary injuries resulting from the use of the baton.

4. Medical Attention: Although the sole intent in the use of a baton is to temporarily disable a subject, the potential for injury exists. When a baton has been used, the subject shall be advised that medical attention is available if desired.

a) The subject shall be transported to a medical facility if:

(1) The subject requests medical attention.
(2) The subject was struck by a baton in the head, neck, or groin.
(3) The subject sustains an injury from a fall after impact from a baton.

5. If the subject was struck by a baton in the head, neck, or groin area, or a secondary injury requires hospitalization, the on-scene supervisor shall request the on-call investigator respond.

6. This policy recognizes that during large crowd control/civil disturbances, it may not be possible to apprehend or treat all the subjects struck or affected by baton strikes.

E. **Reporting:** With the exception of training, deputies shall document all uses of batons in accordance with Sheriff's Office use of force reporting requirements (see G-6110 Use of Force Reporting Requirements).

1. On all operational uses of a baton, the Use of Force Report form shall include:

a) A brief description of the incident.
b) The number of baton strikes and where those strikes impacted on the subject's body, if known.
c) Medical treatment, if any, provided to the subject.
d) A description of the subject's actions after being struck with the baton.
e) A description of any injuries sustained by the subject including secondary injuries that may have occurred.

2. If a baton is used on an animal, the deputy shall complete an information report containing all information required for a Use of Force Report form. All other evidence (e.g. photographs) shall be collected and submitted.